

Software Engineering 2FA3: Discrete Math with Applications II

ADMINISTRATIVE DETAILS

Instructor: Vincent Maccio

Course Website: <http://avenue.mcmaster.ca>

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Office hours: Monday 4:30-5:20

TA Contact:

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TOPICS AND LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Calendar Description: Predicate logic and formal proofs, grammars and automata, modular arithmetic, and their applications to computing.

Learning Objectives: The course will give students a strong understanding of the fundamentals of automata and the theory of computation.

By the end of this course students will be able to:

- Prove a language is regular via several approaches. For example, DFAs, NFAs, grammars, regular expressions, etc.
- Prove a language is non-regular via pumping lemmas.
- Produce and analyze automata: DFA, NFA, PDA, Turing machines.
- Produce and analyze regular expressions.
- Produce and analyze grammars, both regular and context free.
- Understand the difference and be able to determine if a problem is decidable or undecidable.
- Prove sets are countably or uncountably infinite.

MATERIALS & FEES

There is no required text for this course.

Optional Texts:

- Automata and Computability, Dexter C. Kozen

- Formal Languages and Automata, Peter Linz
- Logical Approach to Discrete Math, David Gries and Fred Schneider
- Introduction to the Theory of Computation, Michael Sipser

COURSE OVERVIEW AND ASSESSMENT

All course content, announcements, grades will be made available via Avenue.

Assessments:

Item	Weight	Comments
Assignment 1 (week 5)	10%	DFAs, NFAs, regular languages
Assignment 2 (week 9)	10%	Pumping Lemma, PDA
Midterm (March 4th)	20%	Held during lecture. March 3rd lecture will be a review session. One page cheat sheet allowed front/back.
Assignment 3 (week 12)	10%	TMs, (relatively) advanced topics in automata
Exam (Exam week)	40%	Cumulative. One page cheat sheet allowed front/back.
Floating	10%	The better grade between your midterm and exam.

The due dates above are rough estimations. **I will always give you at least two weeks to complete an assignment from the date I post it.**

The material covered on each assignment is also a rough estimation, if we progress quickly/slowly through the material the coverage may change.

If you have an inquiry regarding your assessment grades, you must contact the TA which graded it within 2 weeks of when the grades are posted. I will make announcements on Avenue informing you which TA(s) graded which assessments. Please contact the TA before contacting me.

There is no grace periods for late assignments. Submit your assignments on time. Late assignments will receive a grade of 0. All assignments are submitted via Avenue.

MSAFs

This is stated below as well. All MSAF'ed assessments will have their weight shifted to the final exam. If you send me a confirmation email regarding an MSAF, it may take several days for me to get back to you – I let them accumulate then do them in batches.

Tutorial Schedule

Tutorial Section	TA
T01	Nishttha Sharma
T02	Nishttha Sharma
T03	Jialin Yu

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: "Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty"), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the Academic Integrity Policy, located at <https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines>

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one's own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

AUTHENTICITY / PLAGIARISM DETECTION

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. **All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld** (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

COURSES WITH AN ON-LINE ELEMENT

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn (A2L), LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, user names for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure please discuss this with the course instructor.

ONLINE PROCTORING

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer

activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

CONDUCT EXPECTATIONS

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities (the “Code”). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online**.

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students’ access to these platforms.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATION OF STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact Student Accessibility Services (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University’s Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities policy.

REQUESTS FOR RELIEF FOR MISSED ACADEMIC TERM WORK

McMaster Student Absence Form (MSAF): In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the Academic Regulation in the Undergraduate Calendar “Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work”.

All missed work will have their weight shifted to the final exam.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATION FOR RELIGIOUS, INDIGENOUS OR SPIRITUAL OBSERVANCES (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the RISO policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office **normally within 10 working days** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

COPYRIGHT AND RECORDING

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

EXTREME CIRCUMSTANCES

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, A2L and/or McMaster email.